and a grey junglefowl, interbred to create a type of bird that could not fly well and that was naturally inclined to domestication.

About five centuries later, large groups of Aryans moved onto the subcontinent, bringing with them herds of domesticated cattle that were used only for milk. According to the beliefs of these pastoral people, cows were a sacred and greatly respected part of daily life, and as such, they were not slaughtered for meat. This idea has persisted in many sects of Hinduism and even inspired vegetarianism in as many as 30 percent of today's Indians —with the help of Buddhism and Jainism. So many early people believed fervently in the good of vegetarianism that about 5,000 years ago the notion of a meatless diet was philosophized as a fundamental part of Jainism. Today, it is mandatory for restaurants in India to mark their dishes with a green or red circle, the former indicating that only vegetarian items were used in its preparation.

Though the Aryans did not harm their cows, they were by no means a vegetarian people. They showed the Harappans how to care for domesticated animals such as goats, which quickly became as popular as chickens for a large portion of ancient carnivorous Indians. Though an unusual ingredient for many Westerners, goat remains prominently on menus throughout modern India. Meat and milk aren't the only important pieces of the puzzle introduced to the delectable Indian culinary palette by central Asia, however; the Aryans also brought along mustard, black pepper, and turmeric.

Due to a constant influx of trade, culture, and people in the northern regions of India, it is here we generally see most central and east Asian influences on the regional cooking. Greek and Chinese conquerors had no such beliefs that stopped them from taking animal lives for consumption and their cooking methods involved a hearty mix of rice, chicken, and citrus fruits. Northern India became a culinary hub known for the use of saffron, rich and creamy korma sauces, cheese, milk, roasted chicken, pork, goat, and the soft, puffy white naan breads of the Afghans. Long before the infamous plantations of Indian tea were so much as cultivated, Indians were enjoying tea shipped from China.

Of course, there were yet more ingredients to discover and develop within local cultures. India has a coastline of 7,517 km (4,671 miles) which makes fishing a logical part of the lives of millions who live within reach of the Arabian Sea, the Bay of Bengal, the Laccadive Sea, and the Andaman Sea.